

“To have a successful tech career, one must truly connect with it”

Kavita Viswanath,
general manager, JFrog India



Kavita Viswanath, general manager, JFrog India, started out on her tech career with a computer science degree nearly two decades back. Since then, she's held many leadership roles in various reputed companies like Oracle, Microsoft and Flipkart. This article is about her journey, the challenges she faced, her achievements, and suggestions on how to build a successful tech career.

Kavita Viswanath's decision to study computer science was primarily because her brother was in the same field. It was also an easy choice for her as she saw that he was quite successful as a software engineer, having started his journey too as a software developer. Viswanath adds that she looked up to her brother in many aspects.

She says, “At that time, my only concern was that I needed to be very successful and at some point, I saw myself starting up a company or heading one. When I saw that my brother had been successful after studying engineering and working for a software company, I thought that would be a good path to work towards my goal. That was only a broad plan. One cannot break it down further at that age as one's exposure is very limited.”

“College is where I first took up leadership roles”

In the first few years, Viswanath says that she was more studious and less entrepreneurial in nature. In the last two years of her education, she started focusing on what else she could do better. In her final year, she became the general manager of the placement cell. It was a position she earned through internal elections, whereby the students chose one of their peers to work with the professors and the industry bodies to get the right kind of companies into the college.

“I saw that as a major step towards achieving my bigger goals. It gave me exposure to companies and an opportunity to represent my college. I was involved in many activities like robotics projects, working closely with

other institutes that wanted to run special projects with my college, etc. My life opened up in the last two years of my engineering degree. That role gave me the opportunity to explore my own leadership skills, work closely with the professors and get to work with the right kind of companies,” says Viswanath.

Hands-on learning

Viswanath got a job through the campus placement, and worked as a software developer for the first two-three years of her career, for a startup in the fintech space. The work involved developing a website with applications in it. It was very new at that point in time.

She says, “I was working very closely with open source technologies. That was the first time I got exposed to open source

